# Beak Trimmer



Category: **Animal Husbandry & Dairy** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 1 labs

**Covers these lab items:** Beak Trimmer

## What it is used for

A beak trimmer is a specialised poultry-care device used by trained personnel to trim or treat the beak according to an approved animal-welfare and veterinary procedure. Correct setup, restraint, equipment calibration, and post-procedure monitoring are essential to minimise pain, bleeding, infection, and stress.

## Main parts

- Trimming or treatment head
- Heated blade, cutting blade, or approved treatment element, depending on model
- Handle or machine frame
- Temperature or operating control, if fitted
- Power supply and protective guard
- Animal restraint or positioning equipment

## Before you start

1. Confirm that the procedure is legally permitted, necessary, and authorised under the applicable veterinary and animal-welfare protocol.
2. Only trained and competent personnel should perform the procedure; obtain veterinary guidance where required.
3. Inspect the device, blade or treatment head, guard, cables, and controls for damage or contamination.
4. Verify that the correct head, operating temperature, or settings are specified for the equipment and procedure.
5. Prepare a clean, well-lit work area and suitable restraint equipment to minimise bird stress and injury.
6. Prepare appropriate hygiene supplies and a plan for bleeding, injury, abnormal distress, or other complications.

## How to use

1. Clean and prepare the equipment according to the manufacturer's instructions and the approved hygiene protocol.
2. Check the blade or treatment head condition and confirm that the device is operating within its specified settings.
3. Handle and restrain the bird gently using the approved method and avoid compressing the chest.

4. Confirm the bird's identity or group and assess its condition before proceeding.
5. Position the beak carefully according to the veterinary or approved procedure; avoid trimming beyond the authorised limit.
6. Activate the device only as instructed and complete the authorised treatment with controlled, consistent technique.
7. Observe the bird immediately for bleeding, burns, breathing difficulty, or unusual distress.
8. Stop the procedure and obtain veterinary assistance if a significant injury, uncontrolled bleeding, or abnormal reaction occurs.
9. Place the bird in a suitable recovery area with access to water and feed according to the care protocol.
10. Monitor feeding, drinking, behaviour, and signs of pain or infection during the required recovery period.
11. Clean and disinfect reusable equipment, dispose of waste safely, and record the procedure and any complications.

## ⚠ Safety

- Do not perform beak trimming without appropriate training, authorisation, and an approved welfare protocol.
- Follow applicable laws and veterinary guidance; do not perform cosmetic or unnecessary procedures.
- Keep fingers away from blades and hot treatment surfaces, and use the specified PPE.
- Do not use equipment with a damaged blade, faulty temperature control, or missing protective guard.
- Avoid excessive restraint and monitor the bird's breathing and stress throughout handling.
- Seek prompt veterinary care for significant bleeding, burns, infection, or persistent inability to eat or drink.

## Care & storage

- Clean and disinfect the device after use according to the manufacturer's instructions.
- Inspect the blade, treatment head, guard, cable, and control system before each session.
- Maintain blade sharpness or replace worn parts only according to the approved service procedure.
- Store the equipment dry, secure, and inaccessible to unauthorised users.
- Review procedure records and animal outcomes to identify equipment or technique problems.

## Common mistakes to avoid

- Performing the procedure without training, veterinary guidance, or proper authorisation.
- Removing more beak tissue than permitted by the approved procedure.
- Using incorrect temperature or damaged equipment.
- Failing to monitor birds for bleeding, distress, or difficulty eating after treatment.

*Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.*